BHMA

CODES IN CONTEXT™

2024 International Building Code (IBC) and International Fire Code (IFC) – Updates Affecting Doors, Door Hardware, and Door Operations

FOCUS:

2024 International Building Code: Automatic Operators at Accessible Public Entrances — Clarifications of requirements, and applications related to buildings with mixed occupancies.

SUMMER 2024 ISSUE

Chapter 11 of the 2021 IBC addresses accessibility requirements and Section 1105.1.1 includes provisions for power-operated doors or low-energy power-operated doors at accessible public entrances. Table 1105.1.1 lists the occupancy types and calculated occupant load thresholds for buildings where the accessible public entrances must have automatic operators.

For Assembly occupancies (with the exception of Group A-5), the requirement for automatic operators on accessible public entrances applies to buildings with a calculated occupant load greater than 300. For Business, Mercantile, and Residential R-1 occupancies (for example: hotels), the requirements apply when the calculated occupant load is greater than 500 people.

TABLE 1105.1.1 PUBLIC ENTRANCE WITH POWER-OPERATED DOOR

OCCUPANCY	BUILDING OCCUPANT LOAD GREATER THAN
A-1, A-2, A-3, A-4	300
B, M, R-1	500



Requirements for automatic operators on accessible public entrances serving certain building types were added to the 2021 IBC, and further modified in the 2024 edition.

The 2024 IBC clarified the requirements that a minimum of one power-operated door or low-energy power-operated door is required at each accessible public entrance within the scope of the requirements. Where these buildings have a vestibule – typically for energy efficiency reasons – a minimum of one set of two doors in series is required to be power-operated.

DISCLAMER: BHMA provides this information as a service, please refer to the jurisdiction's building codes and the project requirements. For any questions, please consult the Authority Having Jurisdiction (AHJ).

The 2024 edition also clarified requirements for mixed-use buildings (buildings with more than one occupancy) in that if the sum of the ratios of the actual occupant load of each occupancy is 1 or greater, then the building is required to comply with the provisions.

> Example 1: A building has an Assembly space with an occupant load of 250 people and a Mercantile occupancy with an occupant load of 75 people, the sum of the ratios would be (250/300) + (75/500) = 0.98. The sum of the ratios is less than 1 and the power-operated door requirements at accessible public entrances would not be applicable to this building.
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> Example 2: A building has an Assembly space with an occupant load of 200 people and a Business occupancy with an occupant load of 250 people, the sum of the ratios would be (200/300) + (250/500) = 1.17. The sum of the ratios is greater than 1 and the power-operated door requirements at accessible public entrances would be applicable to this building.

These new provisions in the IBC address applications not covered by ICC A117.1, *Accessible and Usable Buildings and Facilities* or by federal accessibility rules and regulations, but these are valuable accessibility enhancements for building occupants.



On buildings of the required use groups and occupant loads, accessible public entrances must have at least one automatic door, or one set of automatic doors (for example: exterior and vestibule).

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